

D299

Learning Experience Design Lab

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A distribution center asks for an e-learning module because order-picking errors doubled last quarter. Interviews show pickers know the correct process, but the new handheld scanners freeze and the bonus now rewards speed only. The center recently repainted its aisles and added a break room. What should the designer recommend?

- A. Build a detailed module on the picking process.
- B. Every performance drop needs both training and new tools.
- C. Add aisle signage that matches the new paint colors.
- D. Fix the scanners and rebalance the bonus; a course will not close this gap.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which situation most clearly calls for an instructional solution?

- A. Staff cannot finish reports because the database is down half the day.
- B. Experienced staff skip a safety step because a manager says it slows them down.
- C. Staff know the policy but it is not written anywhere they can find.
- D. Staff must start using a new budgeting system they have never seen.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A designer is writing objectives for a customer-service module that will run on the company's new learning platform. The subject-matter expert has twenty years of experience and likes long lists. Which objective is written best?

- A. Given a recorded complaint call, new agents will identify the customer's issue and propose one policy-compliant solution within two minutes.
- B. New agents will list all twenty years of company service policies.
- C. New agents will understand the importance of good customer service.
- D. The module will present twelve examples of complaint calls.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An objective reads: “Given a sample invoice, new clerks will enter it into the system.” Which ABCD element is missing?

- A.** Audience
- B.** Behavior
- C.** Condition
- D.** Degree

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A lab team is unsure whether learners will follow a branching scenario or a linear case study for a sales module. The budget includes funds for a professional video crew, and the team lead prefers a dark color scheme. What should the team do next?

- A.** Choose the linear case, because branching never works in sales training.
- B.** Build both versions fully and pick one after launch.
- C.** Sketch both paths as paper or slide wireframes and test them with a few learners.
- D.** Film the branching scenario now since the video crew is already funded.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

During a usability session for a new e-learning module, a participant from the target audience cannot find the button to submit a practice quiz. The facilitator, who built the module on a weekend, points to the button so the session can continue. The session was held in a quiet conference room. What is the main problem with this session?

- A.** Helping the participant hid a real navigation problem the test should capture.
- B.** The facilitator should have ended the session as soon as the participant got stuck.
- C.** The session should have been held in a noisier room.
- D.** The participant was not a colleague on the design team.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A peer reviews a classmate's e-learning module on workplace safety using the lab rubric, which has a criterion for "practice with feedback." The classmate works in a large hospital and used a stock photo library. Which comment is most useful?

- A. Great job, this looks really professional!
- B. The practice quiz only shows right or wrong; adding a short reason for each answer would meet the "practice with feedback" criterion.
- C. I would use different stock photos; I don't like these.
- D. The module needs a lot of work everywhere.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

Five pilot users tested a compliance module. Four of five could not submit the final quiz because the button was hidden on small screens. Two disliked the font. One asked for background music. The sponsor wants to add a mascot. Which issue should be fixed first?

- A. Add background music, since it is the easiest change.
- B. The hidden submit button on small screens.
- C. Add the mascot the sponsor wants.
- D. The font, since it was a complaint from more than one person.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A designer has time to fix only one issue before launch. Which issue should be deferred to a later version?

- A. Three of eight users misread a key instruction and did the task wrong.
- B. One of eight users wanted a different shade of blue in the header.
- C. All eight users said the audio cut out mid-lesson.
- D. Five of eight users could not open the final assessment.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A designer finishing her lab module for a nonprofit food bank sends a working draft to three volunteers to find confusing screens before final revisions. The food bank serves six counties. The draft was built in a free authoring tool. What kind of evaluation is this?

- A. It is not evaluation because only three people took part.
- B. A needs assessment.
- C. Formative evaluation.
- D. Summative evaluation, because it happens near the end of the project.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Six months after launch, a company compares error rates of employees who completed a finished module with those who have not yet taken it, to decide whether to keep funding it. What kind of evaluation is this?

- A. Summative evaluation.
- B. Usability testing.
- C. Peer review.
- D. Formative evaluation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A lab team plans to spend eight weeks building a full module, then gather user feedback once in the final week before submitting. The team meets on Tuesdays and uses a shared drive. Which change best reflects an iterative approach?

- A. Extend the build to twelve weeks so the final version is more complete before testing.
- B. Meet twice a week instead of on Tuesdays.
- C. Build and test a small slice every one to two weeks, revising before building the next slice.
- D. Gather feedback once in week one, then build without further testing.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A distribution center asks for an e-learning module because order-picking errors doubled last quarter. Interviews show pickers know the correct process, but the new handheld scanners freeze and the bonus now rewards speed only. ~~The center recently repainted its aisles and added a break room.~~ What should the designer recommend?

Target word: instructional vs. non-instructional fix **Decides:** Pickers already know the process; tools and incentives cause the errors.

A	Adjacent category	Teaches what workers already know.
B	Absolute language	Solutions should match the cause; not every gap needs training.
C	Camouflage	Responds to an irrelevant facility detail.
D	Correct	The gap is not knowledge or skill, so training will not solve it.

2. Answer D Concept 1 • transfer

Which situation most clearly calls for an instructional solution?

Target word: reverse: pick the knowledge/skill gap **Decides:** A task people have never been taught and cannot do.

A	Adjacent category	An environment or tools problem.
B	Confusion set	A management and incentive issue, not a skill gap.
C	Dropped element	Needs a job aid or document, not instruction.
D	Correct	A true skill gap: they have not learned the system.

3. Answer A Concept 2

A designer is writing objectives for a customer-service module ~~that will run on the company's new learning platform.~~ The subject-matter expert ~~has twenty years of experience and likes long lists.~~ Which objective is written best?

Target word: best measurable objective **Decides:** Observable behavior, condition, and criterion are all present.

A	Correct	Audience, observable behavior, condition, and degree are all stated.
B	Camouflage	Pulls in the expert's background; also not a meaningful job task.
C	Dropped element	No observable behavior, condition, or criterion.
D	Inverted operation	Describes what the instruction does, not what the learner does.

4. Answer D Concept 2 • transfer

An objective reads: "Given a sample invoice, new clerks will enter it into the system." Which ABCD element is missing?

Target word: find the missing element **Decides:** No standard of success is stated.

A	Wrong stem number	"New clerks" is the audience.
B	Adjacent category	"Enter it into the system" is observable.
C	Confusion set	"Given a sample invoice" is the condition.
D	Correct	There is no accuracy or time criterion.

5. Answer C Concept 3

A lab team is unsure whether learners will follow a branching scenario or a linear case study for a sales module. The budget includes funds for a professional video crew, and ~~the team lead prefers a dark color scheme~~. What should the team do next?

Target word: next step while the design question is open **Decides:** The core structure has not been tested yet.

A	Absolute language	No design always fails; test instead of assuming.
B	Inverted operation	Spends the most before learning anything.
C	Correct	Cheap prototypes answer the design question before costly production.
D	Camouflage	Available budget does not decide the untested design question.

6. Answer A Concept 4

During a usability session for a new e-learning module, a participant from the target audience cannot find the button to submit a practice quiz. The facilitator, ~~who built the module on a weekend~~, points to the button so the session can continue. ~~The session was held in a quiet conference room~~. What is the main problem with this session?

Target word: flaw in testing method **Decides:** The facilitator helped the user.

A	Correct	Observers should not coach; the struggle is the finding.
B	Adjacent category	Observing how the user recovers is useful data; stopping loses it.
C	Camouflage	The room does not decide the problem.
D	Inverted operation	Representative users are correct; colleagues are the weaker choice.

7. Answer B Concept 5

A peer reviews a classmate's e-learning module on workplace safety using the lab rubric, which has a criterion for "practice with feedback." The classmate ~~works in a large hospital~~ and ~~used a stock photo library~~. Which comment is most useful?

Target word: most useful peer comment **Decides:** Specific, criterion-linked, and actionable.

A	Dropped element	Praise with no specifics or next step.
B	Correct	Specific, tied to the rubric, and gives a next step.
C	Camouflage	Personal taste about an irrelevant detail.
D	Absolute language	Sweeping and not actionable.

8. Answer B Concept 6

Five pilot users tested a compliance module. Four of five could not submit the final quiz because the button was hidden on small screens. Two disliked the font. One asked for background music. ~~The sponsor wants to add a mascot~~. Which issue should be fixed first?

Target word: highest-priority fix **Decides:** The hidden button blocks task completion for 4 of 5 users.

A	Inverted operation	Prioritizes by ease and a single request rather than severity.
B	Correct	Highest severity (blocks completion) and highest frequency (80% of users).
C	Camouflage	Not a user finding at all.
D	Adjacent category	Cosmetic, and less frequent than the blocker.

9. Answer B Concept 6 · transfer

A designer has time to fix only one issue before launch. Which issue should be deferred to a later version?

Target word: reverse: pick the lowest priority **Decides:** Low severity and low frequency.

A	Adjacent category	Moderate frequency but causes wrong performance; more serious than a color.
B	Correct	Cosmetic and reported by one user: lowest severity and frequency.
C	Wrong stem number	Every user hit it; the count makes it urgent.
D	Inverted operation	That is the highest priority, not the one to defer.

10. Answer C Concept 7

A designer finishing her lab module for a nonprofit food bank sends a working draft to three volunteers to find confusing screens before final revisions. ~~The food bank serves six counties. The draft was built in a free authoring tool.~~ What kind of evaluation is this?

Target word: classify the evaluation **Decides:** It is done before final revisions to improve the product.

A	Wrong stem number	Small samples are normal for formative testing.
B	Adjacent category	Needs assessment comes before design, not during revisions.
C	Correct	Its purpose is to improve the draft during development.
D	Confusion set	Timing near the end does not make it summative; purpose does.

11. Answer A Concept 7 · transfer

Six months after launch, a company compares error rates of employees who completed a finished module with those who have not yet taken it, to decide whether to keep funding it. What kind of evaluation is this?

Target word: classify the evaluation **Decides:** Judges a finished product for a keep/drop decision.

A	Correct	It judges the finished product's effectiveness for a decision.
B	Adjacent category	Usability testing checks whether users can operate the product.
C	Confusion set	Peer review is expert feedback, not an outcome comparison.
D	Inverted operation	Formative is for improving a product in development.

12. Answer C Concept 8

A lab team plans to spend eight weeks building a full module, then gather user feedback once in the final week before submitting. ~~The team meets on Tuesdays and uses a shared drive.~~ Which change best reflects an iterative approach?

Target word: iterative plan **Decides:** Feedback is gathered only once, at the end.

A	Dropped element	Still leaves out repeated testing.
B	Camouflage	Meeting schedule is not the issue.
C	Correct	Short loops let feedback shape each version.
D	Inverted operation	Moves the single check instead of repeating it.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	3	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	4	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	7	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Is it an instructional problem?	Training fixes a gap in knowledge or skill; gaps caused by tools, incentives, or unclear expectations need a non-instructional fix.	Assuming every performance problem needs a course.	People who could do the task under other conditions but don't.
2	Measurable objectives (ABCD)	A usable objective names the audience, an observable behavior, the condition, and the degree of success.	Using verbs like understand, know, or appreciate.	Choosing the best-written objective.
3	Low-fidelity prototyping first	Test ideas early with cheap, rough prototypes before investing in polished media.	Building the finished module and testing only at the end.	A design question that is still open while production is being planned.
4	Usability testing with real users	Watch a handful of representative users attempt real tasks and think aloud, without coaching them.	Helping users when they get stuck or testing only with colleagues.	A test session where the facilitator steps in.
5	Quality peer feedback	Useful feedback is specific, tied to criteria, and suggests an actionable next step.	General praise or personal taste counts as feedback.	Choosing the most helpful comment on a peer's module.
6	Prioritizing user feedback	Fix issues first by severity (does it block the task?) and frequency (how many users hit it).	Fixing the loudest or easiest comments first.	A list of issues with counts and effects.
7	Formative vs. summative evaluation	Formative evaluation happens during development to improve the product; summative evaluation judges the finished product's effectiveness.	Labeling any evaluation near the end as summative.	Whether results will change the design or judge it.
8	Iterative design cycles	Design, test, and revise in short repeated loops so user feedback shapes each version.	Treating feedback as a single sign-off step after launch.	A plan that gathers feedback once, at the end.

Course scope (public description): Learning Experience Design Lab requires learners to apply foundational learning experience design strategies to create an instructional solution in the form of an e-learning module. In the course, learners will identify an instructional problem and then design and develop a functional prototype of an e-learning solution. Learning Experience Design Lab provides an environment for learners to apply foundational knowledge and skills, experiment with various e-learning design tools and techniques, provide helpful quality feedback to peers, and receive quality feedback from peers about their own e-learning module. Finally, Learning Experience Design Lab teaches the importance of obtaining user feedback and incorporating that feedback to continuously improve the learning experience. Degree-seeking learners must complete the Learning Experience Design foundations series and two pathway courses prior to completing this course.